



Ethicare Resourcing

SOUTH ISLAND GUIDE · 2026

RELOCATION GUIDE

Dunedin

Ōtepoti

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Dunedin.

A leading teaching hospital. A fifteen-minute commute.

Dunedin wins people over the moment they visit. It has grand Victorian stone, the country's oldest medical school, wildlife you would normally book a boat to see, and the most affordable housing of any of New Zealand's main centres.

~130k

people in the city

~20k

university students

15 min

typical commute

20 min

to albatross, penguins
and sea lions

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why people love Dunedin

Dunedin offers the same national pay and a tertiary case mix as the big cities, in a city where you can own a character home ten minutes from work.

The Scots founded it in 1848 and built it in stone. When gold was found in Central Otago in the 1860s, Dunedin briefly became the largest and richest city in New Zealand, and it spent that money on architecture: a railway station that looks like a Flemish town hall, banks with marble floors, grand churches on every rise. The gold rush passed. The buildings stayed.

What keeps it lively now is the university. Around 20,000 students in a city of roughly 130,000 is a ratio no other New Zealand city comes close to, and it shows in the bars, the music, and a southern city that supports a serious art gallery and three good museums.



The railway station, built on gold-rush money. Its car park hosts the Saturday farmers' market.

NATIONAL PAY, LOCAL HOUSING

Your salary goes furthest here

The number on your contract is the same as Auckland's. Housing costs far less, and that difference grows every year you stay.

TEACHING BUILT IN

A medical school next door

If teaching, research or supervision is part of how you want to work, the infrastructure is already here and the door is open.

15 MINUTES

Your evening back

For a lot of people this is the change they notice most: arriving home before six with the day still in it.

PENINSULA AND COAST

Nature without the drive

The Otago Peninsula starts at the edge of town and surf beaches are ten minutes from the centre. This is everyday life, not something saved for annual leave.

WHAT YOU GAIN

The best-value housing

Of any main centre, by a clear margin. Consultants buy the kind of house they had stopped imagining.

An academic culture

Remarkable for a city this size, and the best-value place in the country to teach or publish.

Wildness close by

Nowhere else in New Zealand puts this much wild coast this close to a tertiary hospital.

GOOD TO KNOW

Plan your travel

Christchurch is about four and a half hours by road or a short flight, and long-haul trips start with a connection. Book ahead and it is easy.

Choose a warm house

Many homes are characterful older villas. Pick one that is insulated and well heated and it is a joy all year.

Partner careers

Health, education and the university are the big employers. If your partner works in another field, start the conversation early and we can help.

A compact city in a big landscape

Dunedin sits at the head of a long, narrow harbour, with hills on three sides and the open Pacific on the fourth. That shape explains almost everything about how the city works.

HARBOUR HEAD

The flat and the centre

The Octagon, the university, the hospital and the warehouse precinct, all on reclaimed flat land. Walkable, and where most of the working day happens.

WESTERN SLOPE

The hill suburbs

Roslyn, Māori Hill, Mornington and their neighbours. Views, villas, good schools, steep streets, and a few degrees cooler than the flat.

SOUTH

The coast

St Clair and St Kilda face the open sea. Andersons Bay and Musselburgh sit behind them, sheltered and popular with families.

TWO MOODS

The peninsula and the plain

The Otago Peninsula runs twenty kilometres to Taiaaroa Head. The Taieri Plain, with Mosgiel and the airport, sits over the hill to the south-west.



Baldwin Street in North East Valley. Gradient here is part of the charm.

Summer

DEC – FEB

18–22°C. Light until after 9pm. Warm days are genuinely warm; cool ones need a jacket.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

12–18°C. Often the best of the year: settled, clear and golden, with the students back.

Winter

JUN – AUG

4–11°C. Mild for the latitude. Snow dusts the hills a few times a season, and June evenings by the fire start around 5pm.

Spring

SEP – NOV

10–17°C. Changeable and breezy. The peninsula is at its best as the seabirds return.

The sea moderates the climate in both directions. The mean annual temperature is around 11°C, and winter days sit around 10°C, milder than most of the UK. The year is defined less by cold than by variety. A February day can be 25°C and still, the next week 15°C and cloudy, so locals dress in layers and enjoy whatever arrives.

Being this far south means long, golden summer evenings and shorter winter days. Locals make the most of both: late beach walks in January, fires and good food in July. If short days affect you, a bright, north-facing home makes a real difference.



Wide, empty beaches lie within the city boundary, out on the peninsula.

Healthcare and work in Dunedin

The city's tertiary hospital serves the lower South Island, run by Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora. What makes it distinctive is the university next door.

The hospital provides the full range of secondary services for the city and wider Otago, and tertiary services for a catchment reaching south to Southland and inland across Central Otago. New Zealand's first medical school sits immediately alongside. Joint appointments are common, students and registrars are everywhere, and research is a normal part of the working environment rather than something you do in your own time.

The practical effect is a case mix broader than the city's size suggests, delivered by teams close-knit enough that you will know everyone in your specialty within a fortnight.

What the catchment means for your work

- ✓ Broad scope: close-knit teams mean wide-ranging work, and most people find that a real draw.
- ✓ Access is informal: you phone the consultant rather than the department. Decisions that take a week elsewhere can take an afternoon.
- ✓ Distance shapes decisions: when the alternative is a long transfer, thresholds and planning look different.
- ✓ Seasonal swing: students and summer visitors both move demand. Winter is the busiest season, as it is across the country.

ASK AT INTERVIEW

A campus being renewed

A major, long-term rebuild of the Dunedin campus is underway. Ask about timelines and interim arrangements for your service; the picture differs by department.

MINUTES FROM THE PUBLIC CAMPUS

The private sector

A focused private sector: planned surgery, endoscopy, diagnostics. A public list in the morning and a private one in the afternoon is a ten-minute drive.

ACROSS OTAGO

Rural and regional links

Rural hospitals, community services and outreach clinics. Generalist scope and real autonomy.

BEYOND THE ACUTE ROSTER

Imaging and aged care

Community radiology and a substantial aged residential care sector, often with more predictable hours.

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Everyday care for your household

Popular GP practices fill up, so enrol as soon as you have an address. The city has after-hours accident and medical services for most of what would otherwise reach an emergency department. Adult dental care is private, as everywhere in New Zealand; it is free for under-18s.



Rehabilitation, step by step.



Teaching hospitals mean colleagues who like to share what they know.

Where to live in Dunedin

Dunedin is compact, so nothing is far, and choosing a suburb comes down to which contour line you live on, which way the house faces, and how warm it is.

The flat is walkable and close to work. The hill gives you views and character housing, a touch cooler than the flat. The coast gives you a beach at the end of the street and the smell of the sea. Drive all three before you decide.

Then ask about warmth. Much of the housing is a century old, full of character and originally built without insulation. A well-retrofitted villa is lovely, so check for upgrades. And on a hill this far south, a north-facing section soaks up winter sun, while a south-facing one in a valley may see little between May and August.

SUBURB	CHARACTER	SUITS	TO THE CENTRAL CAMPUS
Central city	Compact, characterful, relaxed at weekends	Couples, anyone who would rather not own a car	3 min
North Dunedin	Student heartland: lively in term	Registrars for a year, before moving up the hill	5 min
North East Valley	Best-value character housing within walking distance	First-home buyers	8 min
Opoho	Leafy, established, harbour views	Families and consultants	8 min
Roslyn	The classic hill suburb with a village of shops	Families wanting the traditional Dunedin house	8 min
Mornington	A hill suburb with great value	Families wanting the hill without the premium	8 min
St Clair	Surf beach, esplanade, saltwater pool	Families, surfers, early swimmers	12 min
Andersons Bay	Settled, suburban, full of families	Families with school-age children	10 min

SUBURB	CHARACTER	SUITS	TO THE CENTRAL CAMPUS
Portobello & the peninsula	Rural, spectacular, a real community	People who want space and sea views, 25 minutes from work	25 min
Mosgiel	Its own town on the plain, warmer and sunnier	Families wanting a warm modern house	22 min



Space, greenery and a view: the classic Dunedin hill house.



Older brick and weatherboard houses, full of character. Ask about insulation and heating before you ask about the view.

Before you sign

- ☐ Ask when the house was last insulated, whether it is double glazed, and what the heating is.
- ☐ Visit in the morning and again at four o'clock to see where the sun actually falls.
- ☐ Walk the specific street. Some are wonderfully steep, and a handful are best avoided on the rare snow day.
- ☐ Time your search: December and January are the easiest months to find a family home; February is the busiest.
- ☐ Rent for six months first. It tells you whether you want the hill, the flat or the coast.

Getting around a compact, hilly city

Dunedin is one of the easiest cities in New Zealand to get around, for one simple reason: everything is close. The thing to plan for is the hills.

Fifteen minutes door to door is normal from most suburbs, twenty-five from Mosgiel over the hill. The rush hour is a courtesy title: it means the lights take two cycles instead of one. Parking around the hospital and university is in demand, so check what comes with a rental.

The flat is entirely walkable. The Octagon, the university, the hospital and the warehouse precinct are within fifteen minutes of each other on foot. The Orbus network radiates from the centre and works well on the main corridors, with lighter services in the evenings and on the hills.

15 min

from most
suburbs to work

~30 min

to the airport on
the Taieri Plain

~2½ hr

to Invercargill

4½ hr

to Christchurch
by road

Cycling is excellent on the flat and along the harbour, and e-bikes have made the hill routes easy too. In winter, frost and ice on steep streets call for care: a front- or four-wheel-drive car and a north-facing driveway make July mornings simple.

A car comes into its own at the weekend rather than for the commute: the peninsula, the beaches, Central Otago and the Catlins. One per household is usually enough.

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Planning trips home

The airport has domestic connections and some trans-Tasman flights. Long-haul trips connect through Auckland, Christchurch or Sydney, so allow an extra half-day each way. Plan for it from the start and visits home stay easy.

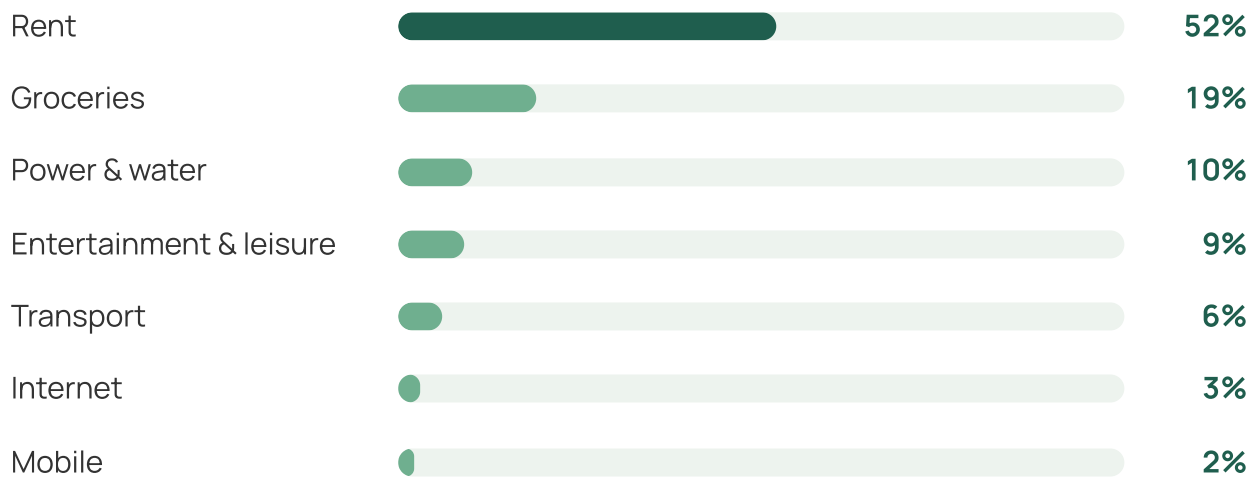
What it costs to live here

The salary on your contract is the same one you would earn in Auckland. It simply buys considerably more here, and a little of the difference keeps your home beautifully warm.

We do not print rents or monthly budgets, because figures date quickly. What stays true is the shape of a month, and a sense of which lines will surprise you.

Rents and house prices are well below Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch. A family home in a good suburb costs what a small flat costs further north. Short commutes and cheap parking outside the campus mean many households run one car instead of two.

Where a month goes



One person on a mid-range budget. Proportions, not amounts.

Power is the line to plan for. An older house without insulation can cost two or three times as much to heat in July as to run in February; the same house, insulated and with an efficient heat pump, costs a fraction of that. Healthy Homes standards have lifted rental quality. If you buy, treat insulation and heating as part of the price.

NOT AN AVERAGE

Ask for a July bill

Landlords and vendors can usually produce recent power bills. Ask for the winter one specifically.

THREE THINGS

Look for the retrofit

Ceiling and underfloor insulation, a heat pump, and double glazing in the main rooms. A villa with all three is genuinely warm.

ASPECT MATTERS

Sun is free heating

A north-facing living room does more for your winter than any appliance.

TIME YOUR SEARCH

The student effect

Rental demand peaks in late January and February and eases from November. Search in December if you can.



A garden big enough for a barbecue is one of the things a Dunedin salary still buys.

THREE COSTS WORTH PLANNING FOR

- ✓ Flights home: every long-haul journey involves at least one connection. Budget the fare and the extra half-day.
- ✓ Heating: the biggest local budget line in an older villa that has not been upgraded, and a small one in a house that has.
- ✓ Setting up: bond, rent in advance, a car, whiteware, and whatever it takes to make a character house cosy.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Dunedin

Dunedin suits clinicians who want a teaching hospital's rigour without a big city's costs, and who like that the beach at the end of the road has sea lions on it. People arrive curious and stay because of how ordinary it becomes to have albatross on a Saturday.

The one thing I always mention is the house. Ask about insulation and heating before you ask about the view. A warm villa is a joy, and choosing well is the easiest way to love your first winter.

And plan your trips home from the start. Pack for the weather, book ahead for the distance, and Dunedin gives back far more than it asks.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Bush, beach and hills are close enough for an after-work walk.

Food, cafés and culture

A city of 130,000 has a remarkable number of good places to eat, thanks to 20,000 students who need feeding cheaply and a century and a half of Scottish, Chinese and more recent Asian and Middle Eastern settlement.

The Otago Farmers Market runs every Saturday morning beside the railway station, and it is the closest thing the city has to a weekly civic ritual. Producers come in from the Taieri, Central Otago and the Catlins. It is a locals' market: most of the city shops there, and after a couple of months you will recognise half the queue.



You go for the vegetables and stay for the coffee and the whitebait fritter.

THE CENTRE

The Octagon

Bars and restaurants ring the plaza, and on a warm evening the tables spill onto the grass in front of the town hall.

VOGEL AND BOND STREETS

The warehouse precinct

Restored Victorian warehouses turned into restaurants, breweries and design studios. The best-looking few blocks in the city.

ON THE SURF

St Clair Esplanade

Breakfast here on a clear Sunday is one of the reasons people move.

15 MIN UP THE HARBOUR

Port Chalmers

A working port with a lively arts and food scene of its own.

Dunedin takes brewing seriously, with several breweries running taprooms you can walk between. The public art gallery is free and genuinely good, there are three museums worth your time, and the student population keeps live music thriving with the energy of a much bigger city.

Several well-stocked Asian grocers near the university and in the centre cover most ingredients the supermarkets miss, and the city's second-hand and antique trade is unusually good for furnishing a large old house.

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Te reo Māori place names

Ōtepoti is Dunedin's name in te reo Māori. Kāi Tahu is the principal iwi of the South Island, and their story runs through the harbour, the peninsula and the city's place names.



The university gives the city its students, and the students give it its cafés.

Weekends on the wildlife coast

Weekends are one of the best reasons to live in Dunedin. Wild coast, wildlife and good walks start at the edge of town.

The Otago Peninsula is the single best thing about living here. At Taiaroa Head is the only mainland breeding colony of royal albatross, birds with a two-metre wingspan nesting on a headland you can drive to. Along the way there are yellow-eyed penguins, little blue penguins, sea lions and fur seals, and a road that hugs the harbour the whole way.

People who move here from cities where nature is a holiday activity soon find it part of everyday life, and the delight never quite wears off.



A harbour road under gorse-gold hills. Twenty minutes out, the city gives way to this.



Sandfly Bay: a steep dune descent to a wild beach where sea lions haul out.



Keep your distance. The sea lions are large and faster than they look.

~10 min

to the surf at St Clair and St Kilda

~30 min

to Taiaroa Head

1 hr+

to the Catlins

A weekend

for Central Otago and the ski fields

What people do at the weekend

- ✓ Saturday morning at the Otago Farmers Market beside the railway station, then coffee in the Octagon.
- ✓ Wildlife on the peninsula: albatross at Taiaroa Head, then Sandfly Bay at dusk for penguins and sea lions.
- ✓ Kids' sport on Saturday mornings, Moana Pool, and rugby or a concert at the covered stadium.
- ✓ A surf or a walk at St Clair, and a swim in the heated saltwater pool on the Esplanade.
- ✓ Walks and mountain-bike trails in the town belt, Ross Creek and Signal Hill, minutes from the suburbs.
- ✓ Day trips to the Catlins, Moeraki or Central Otago's rail trail and vineyards.



Tautuku Bay in the Catlins, one of the South Island's most peaceful corners.

The southern coast is cool and powerful, which is exactly why surfers love it. Wetsuits are standard and rips can be strong, so swim between the flags at patrolled beaches like St Clair. Summers are mild and fresh, with space, peace and a landscape most people only see on holiday.



Pīwakawaka (fantails) follow walkers along the bush tracks.



The koru: a fern unfolding, and a symbol of new beginnings.

Day trips and weekends around Otago

Dunedin sits at a crossroads of some of New Zealand's best country: the wildlife coast, the Catlins, the Waitaki's Victorian towns and Central Otago's lakes and mountains.

Close to home, the Otago Peninsula, Orokonui Ecosanctuary and Tunnel Beach are all within an easy drive. An hour or so north are the Moeraki Boulders and Oamaru, with its whitestone Victorian precinct and little blue penguins. South-west lie the Catlins, all rainforest, waterfalls and empty beaches.

Inland, Central Otago's vineyards, lakes and the Otago Central Rail Trail make a natural weekend. Queenstown and Wānaka, with their ski fields, are a longer trip, and Christchurch is the nearest larger city when you want a change of pace or an international flight.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
St Clair & St Kilda beaches	About 10 min	The nearest surf beaches, the Esplanade cafés and the heated saltwater pool
Tunnel Beach	About 15 min	A clifftop walk and a hand-carved tunnel down to a hidden beach
Orokonui Ecosanctuary	About 20 min	Predator-fenced native forest, alive with birdsong
Dunedin Airport	About 30 min	Domestic flights and some trans-Tasman services
Taiaroa Head	About 30–45 min	Royal albatross, penguins and seals at the tip of the peninsula
Moeraki Boulders	About 1 hr	The famous spherical boulders on the beach, and fresh fish in the village
Oamaru	About 1½ hrs	Victorian whitestone streets and a little blue penguin colony
The Catlins	About 1½ hrs	Nugget Point, waterfalls and forest walks
Central Otago	About 2 hrs	Vineyards, orchards, the rail trail and dry, sunny summers
Nearest ski fields	About 3½ hrs	Coronet Peak, the Remarkables and Cardrona near Queenstown and Wānaka make a great winter weekend

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Christchurch	About 4½–5 hrs by road, or a 1 hr flight	The nearest larger city, and long-haul international flights

20–45 MIN

Otago Peninsula

Larnach Castle, Portobello's cafés, and the albatross colony at Taiaroa Head. A different day out every time.

ABOUT 20 MIN

Orokonui Ecosanctuary

A fenced forest sanctuary north of the city where native birds such as kākā thrive. Dunedin's answer to Wellington's Zealandia.

ABOUT 15 MIN

Tunnel Beach

A short, steep walk to sandstone cliffs and a tunnel carved by hand in the 1870s. Best at low tide.

1–1½ HRS

Moeraki & Oamaru

Boulders on the beach, then Oamaru's Victorian precinct, steampunk museum and penguins at dusk.

ABOUT 1½ HRS

The Catlins

Nugget Point lighthouse, Purakaunui Falls and long, quiet beaches. Lovely as a day, better as a weekend.

1–2 HRS

Otago Central Rail Trail

A gentle, mostly flat cycle trail through Central Otago, with bike hire and country pubs along the way. Families do it in sections.

ABOUT 3½ HRS

Queenstown & Wānaka

Lakes, mountains and the nearest ski fields. A classic long weekend for Dunedin families.



Oamaru's whitestone Victorian buildings, about an hour and a half up the coast.



Autumn vines beside Lake Wānaka, in the Central Otago high country.



A chairlift at the Remarkables above Queenstown. The nearest ski fields are a winter weekend away, about 3½ hours.

Schools and family life

Beaches, the peninsula, good schools, short commutes and a safe, walkable city. Children here grow up with wildlife and wild coast as part of an ordinary week.

Family life in Dunedin runs at an easy pace. Short commutes mean parents are home for dinner and Saturday sport, and most suburbs are a few minutes from a park, a beach or a bush track. It is a safe city, and children tend to have more freedom to walk, bike and bus on their own than they would in a big city.

There is plenty to do. Moana Pool is a large indoor aquatic centre with hydroslices, the Botanic Garden has a playground and aviaries, and the city libraries run free holiday and storytime programmes. Clubs cover rugby, netball, football, hockey, surf lifesaving, swimming and more.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Tūhura Otago Museum, with its hands-on science centre and tropical butterfly house.
- ✓ The heated saltwater pool and rock pools at St Clair.
- ✓ Spotting sea lions, penguins and albatross on the peninsula.
- ✓ Snow on the hills a few times a winter, close enough for a snowman before school.
- ✓ Saturday morning sport, then the farmers' market for breakfast.

State schooling is free at primary and secondary level, though schools ask for a voluntary donation. Alongside state schools there are state-integrated schools, many with a church character, and a few independent schools. Popular schools run enrolment zones, so check the zone for an exact address before you sign a lease.

The city has long-established secondary schools, including Otago Boys' and Otago Girls' High Schools and King's and Queen's High Schools. The hill suburbs of Roslyn and Māori Hill, plus Andersons Bay, Opoho and Mosgiel, are popular with families for their schools. Read any school's report from the Education Review Office at ero.govt.nz.

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Early childhood and beyond school

New Zealand funds up to 20 hours a week of early childhood education for three to five-year-olds at participating centres, and Dunedin has kindergartens, playcentres and childcare centres across the city. For school leavers, the University of Otago and Otago Polytechnic are both here, so many students study without leaving home.

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The job is interesting, the commute is a breeze, and the weekend starts fifteen minutes from your door.



Time on the water is an ordinary weekend here, not a holiday.



Little ones ride, big ones walk.

FOR FAMILIES, IN SHORT

- ✓ A character family home is well within reach here, more so than further north.
- ✓ Put some of the saving into warmth. It is what makes an old house a home you love.
- ✓ North Dunedin is the lively student quarter; families tend to look up the hill, on the coast or in Mosgiel.
- ✓ Enrol everyone with a GP as soon as you have an address.

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A compact city in a big landscape, with a quality of life that stays with you.

Your Dunedin address book

Dunedin's migrant communities are smaller and closely tied to the university and hospital. The Dunedin Multi-Ethnic Council is the main hub, there are active Tamil and Pasifika networks, and Malayalam Mar Thoma and Syro-Malabar services are nearest in Christchurch.

COUNCIL AND CITY SERVICES

Dunedin City Council

Rubbish and recycling, rates, libraries, pools and building consents

dunedin.govt.nz

Otago Regional Council

The regional council, and the Orbus bus network in Dunedin

orc.govt.nz

EXPLORING THE CITY AND THE COAST

Dunedin NZ

The city's official visitor and events guide

dunedinnz.com

Otago Museum

Natural history, Pacific and Māori collections and a tropical butterfly house; general entry is free

otagomuseum.nz

Toitū Otago Settlers Museum

The story of the city and its people, free to enter, beside the railway station

toitu.co.nz

Department of Conservation

Tracks, huts and wildlife guidance for the peninsula, the Catlins and beyond

doc.govt.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Dunedin Multi-Ethnic Council

The umbrella body for ethnic communities: women's Chai & Chat, a men's group, a migrant worker programme and Race Relations Week events.

dmec.org.nz

Dunedin Tamil Society

Tamil language, music and drama, plus social support and festivals for Tamil-speaking families.

dunedintamilsociety.org.nz

Dunedin Korean Language & Culture Society

Korean language and cultural community group listed with the Ministry for Ethnic Communities.

Pasifika communities directory (Dunedin City Council)

The council's directory of Pacific church, cultural and community groups in Dunedin.

dunedin.govt.nz/services/community-support/pasifika-communities-in-otepoti-dunedin-directory

New to Dunedin (Dunedin City Council)

The council's newcomer pages on housing, banking, schools, English classes and getting around.

dunedin.govt.nz/services/new-to-dunedin

English Language Partners Dunedin

Free English classes, ESOL road code, workplace English and volunteer home tutors; Level 6, 43 Princes St.

03 455 5266 englishlanguage.org.nz/dunedin

New Zealand Newcomers Network

Coffee mornings and social events for people new to the area; find the Dunedin group on the site.

newcomers.co.nz

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with anything from tenancy to tax, with interpreters available.

0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

English Language Partners Dunedin (Facebook)

Class news and conversation groups.

facebook.com/EnglishLanguagePartnersDunedin

Hare Krishna Dunedin (ISKCON)

News of programmes and festivals at the London St centre.

facebook.com/Hare-Krishna-Dunedin-Iskcon-1457100871226976

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Joseph's Cathedral (Catholic)

The Catholic cathedral in central Dunedin; the diocese also has a Samoan Catholic community.

Syro-Malabar Catholic Mission, Christchurch

No Malayalam Syro-Malabar mass in Dunedin; the nearest regular Qurbana is in Christchurch.

syromalabarchristchurch.org.nz

Christchurch Mar Thoma Parish

Mar Thoma parish that serves the whole South Island, Otago included; ask about services nearer Dunedin.

christchurchmarthoma.org

St Paul's Cathedral (Anglican)

The Anglican cathedral on the Octagon.

Knox Church (Presbyterian)

Historic city-centre church; Dunedin's Scottish Presbyterian heritage is strong.

Al-Huda Mosque (Otago Muslim Association)

Central Dunedin mosque, open since 2000, for daily and Friday prayers and classes.

Hare Krishna Dunedin (ISKCON)

Hindu (Vaishnava) centre at 133 London St with programmes and festivals.

Gurudwara Singh Sabha Trust, Dunedin

Sikh trust set up in 2024 for worship, langar and learning in Dunedin.

Dunedin Jewish Congregation

The world's southernmost synagogue, in North Dunedin; Progressive services about one Friday a month and on most festivals.

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

ISM Mart (Indian Save Mart)

Indian and South Asian groceries (2,000+ lines including Kerala brands) at 199 King Edward St, South Dunedin; online shop too.

03 455 2011 ismdn.co.nz

Indian Food Mart

Indian, Middle Eastern and Sri Lankan spices, lentils and groceries at 84 St Andrew St.

03 471 8447

Asian grocers near the university

Several student-oriented Asian and Middle Eastern grocers around North Dunedin and the centre.

Halal meat

Ask at Al-Huda Mosque for current halal butchers and suppliers; many supermarket meat lines are halal-certified.

Kosher food

No kosher shop locally; the Dunedin Jewish Congregation can advise on ordering from the North Island.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Pak'nSave

The cheapest of the big chains, warehouse-style. Use the store finder for the nearest Dunedin store.

paknsave.co.nz/store-finder

Woolworths

Mid-range chain with the best online ordering and delivery. Stores in Dunedin; larger stores are on the flat and in Mosgiel.

woolworths.co.nz

New World

Slightly pricier, with a better fresh and speciality range. Stores in Dunedin; use the store finder.

newworld.co.nz

Otago Farmers Market

Every Saturday 8am to 12:30pm beside the Dunedin Railway Station; food from across Otago.

otagofarmersmarket.org.nz

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts school finder

Find schools near an address and check which school zone a house falls in.

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

NZ Uniforms

Uniform stockist with a Dunedin store; also check each school's own uniform shop and PTA second-hand sales.

nzuniforms.com

Plunket

Free health and development checks for under-fives, parent groups and PlunketLine advice (0800 933 922).

0800 933 922 plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood centres and playgroups, good for meeting other families.

playcentre.org.nz

Dunedin Public Libraries

Free city and branch libraries with storytimes, holiday programmes and free wifi.

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property: Dunedin rentals

The main rental listings site; most landlords and agents list here.

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/otago/dunedin

realestate.co.nz: Dunedin rentals

Second listings site, mainly agency-managed rentals.

realestate.co.nz/residential/rental/otago/dunedin-city

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Look up what similar homes actually rent for, by suburb and bedrooms.

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Dunedin City Council rates search

Check the rates for any address before you buy.

dunedin.govt.nz/do-it-online/search/rates

GETTING AROUND

Orbus Dunedin (Otago Regional Council)

City and suburban buses, with a journey planner and real-time tracking.

0800 672 8736 orc.govt.nz/orbus

Bee Card

Otago's bus fare card, cheaper than cash; Motu Move is due to replace it.

beecard.co.nz

Dunedin Airport

At Momona, about 30 minutes south; domestic flights and some trans-Tasman services.

dunedinairport.co.nz

InterCity

Long-distance coaches linking South Island towns and cities.

intercity.co.nz

NZ Transport Agency (NZTA)

Converting an overseas licence, road rules and live road conditions.

nzta.govt.nz

AA

Licence tests and conversions, vehicle checks and roadside membership at AA centres.

aa.co.nz

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo: Dunedin

Crowd-sourced prices to compare with your home city.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Dunedin

Powerswitch

Compare power and broadband plans for your address.

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free budgeting and money tools from the Retirement Commission.

sorted.org.nz

Stats NZ

Official prices, incomes and census data by area.

stats.govt.nz



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

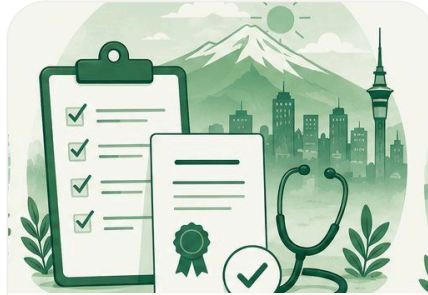
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

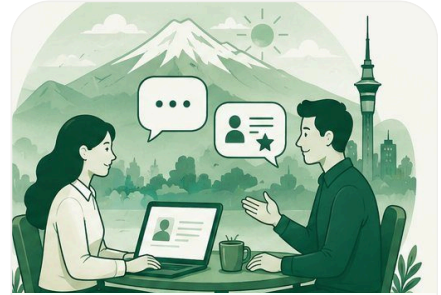
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

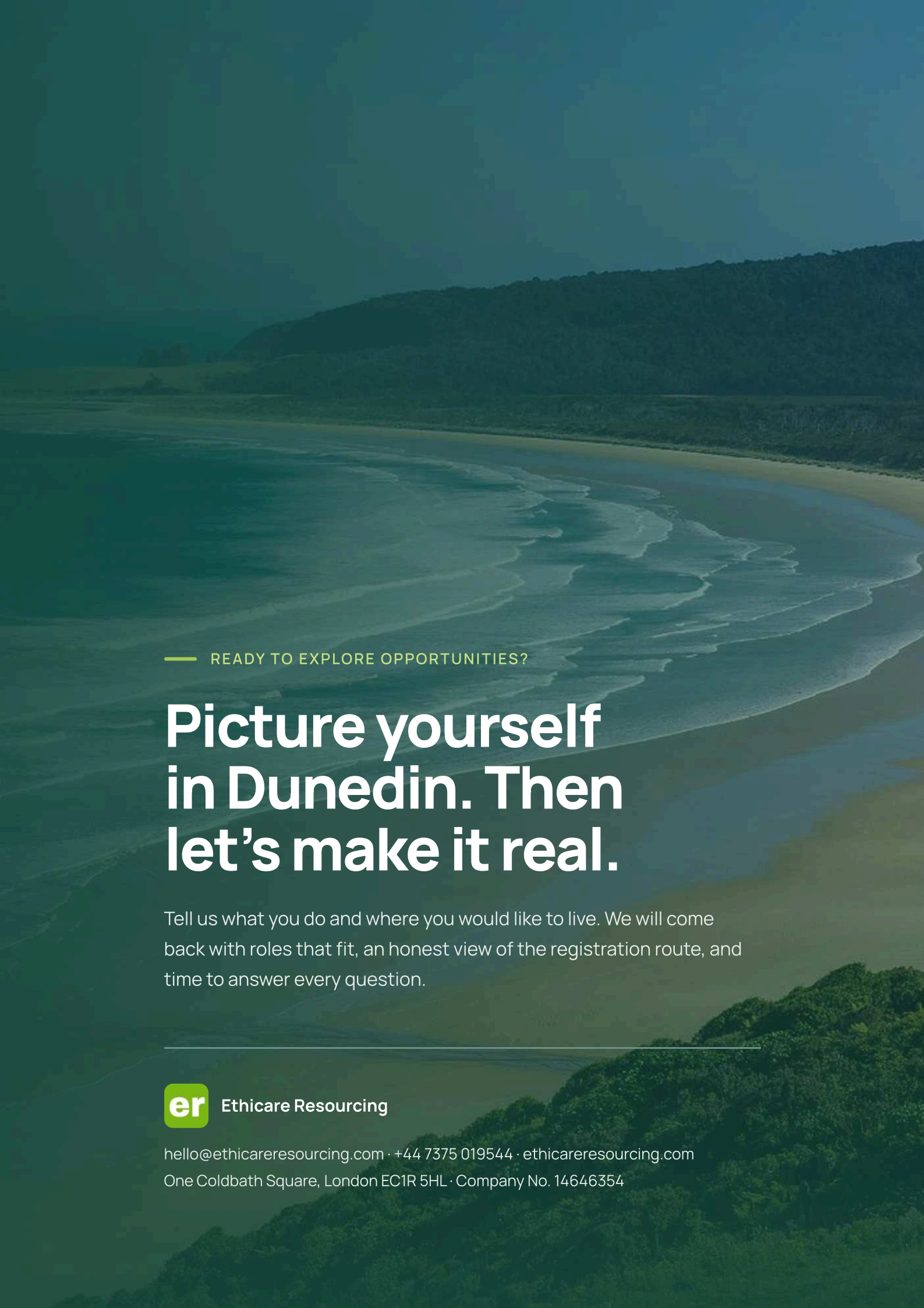
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Dunedin. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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